TGPSC Group 1 Mains

Paper II · Unit I · Topic 3

British Colonial Expansion and Economic Transformation

Expanded draft — source and official PYQ verification pending

Contents

Syllabus & Index

Quick Revision

Detailed Notes

Visual Learning

Original Practice

Answer Blueprints

Complete Model Answers

Verified MCQs

Verified Mains PYQs

Current Affairs

References

Quality Audit

Syllabus & Index

The Establishment of British Colonial Rule in India: Carnatic Wars , Battle of Plassey, Anglo- Mysore, Anglo-Maratha and Anglo-Sikh Wars; Economic Impact of British Colonial Rule: Land Revenue Settlements in British India; -Commercialization of Agriculture; Rise of Landless Agrarian Labour; Famines and Poverty;De-industrialization; Decline of Traditional Crafts; Drain of Wealth; Growth of Trade and Commerce- Economic Transformation of India; Railroads, Transport and Communication Network- Telegraph and Postal Services.

Study map

1. Carnatic, Plassey, Mysore, Maratha and Sikh wars: detailed notes §§1–2.

2. Revenue settlements, commercialization, landless labor: §3.

3. Famines, deindustrialization, drain and trade: §§4–5.

4. Railways, telegraph and post: §5.

5. Telangana comparative context: §5.4.

Syllabus transcription inherited from the existing project. Independent current-notification amendment check remains pending.

Quick Revision

Military-political timeline

Event	Date	Why it matters
First Carnatic War	1746–48	European rivalry becomes entangled with Indian politics
Battle of Plassey	1757	Company influence in Bengal through military action and elite defection
Battle of Wandiwash	1760	Decisive British victory over French forces in the Carnatic
Battle of Buxar	1764	Company defeats coalition of major regional powers
Bengal diwani	1765	Revenue rights create a fiscal-military base
Permanent Settlement	1793	Zamindari revenue demand fixed in Bengal
Fall of Tipu Sultan	1799	Fourth Anglo-Mysore War ends
Treaty of Bassein	1802	Peshwa accepts subsidiary alliance
Final Anglo-Maratha War	1817–18	Peshwa's political office abolished
Punjab annexation	1849	After Second Anglo-Sikh War
Bombay–Thane railway	1853	First passenger railway service
Awadh annexation	1856	Justified by British as misgovernment, not Doctrine of Lapse

Compare revenue systems

System	Main assessment unit	Key issue
Permanent	Zamindar	Fixed state demand; tenants vulnerable to landlord exactions
Ryotwari	Individual cultivator	Direct assessment but periodic revision and high demands
Mahalwari	Village estate or mahal	Joint responsibility and periodic reassessment

Five analytical distinctions

1. Plassey vs Buxar: political leverage through elite conspiracy vs consolidated military authority against a coalition.

2. Commercialization vs prosperity: more cash-crop production need not raise real incomes.

3. Craft decline vs all industry: traditional sector contraction coexisted with later modern industrial growth.

4. Railway capacity vs food security: movement of grain does not guarantee poor people can afford it.

5. Direct British India vs Hyderabad State: do not apply provincial settlements mechanically to Telangana.

Mains-ready causal chain

Company alliances and battles → fiscal rights → land and trade restructuring → uneven commercialization and industrial change → famines, resistance and economic nationalism.

Detailed Notes

Paper II · Unit I · Topic 3 — expanded analytical draft; not approved

1. From commercial company to territorial state

1.1 The company-state problem

The English East India Company began as a chartered trading corporation, not as a national administration of India. Its transformation into a territorial power depended on armed commerce, private fortunes, credit networks, alliances with Indian elites and the weakening of effective central Mughal authority. The Mughal decline did not create a political vacuum: Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad, Mysore, the Maratha confederacy and Sikh polities exercised substantial authority. Company victories therefore arose from contests among existing states, not from an automatic technological superiority over a passive subcontinent.

1.2 Trade, fiscal power and military recruitment

Control of customs concessions and trading privileges could undermine the revenue base of an Indian government. Once the Company acquired the Bengal diwani in 1765, it could use local revenue to pay troops and buy Indian goods, reducing its dependence on bullion imported from Europe. This fiscal-military loop mattered more than a simple list of battles: territorial taxes financed armies, armies secured more territory, and territory expanded taxable resources. Indian bankers, suppliers, sepoys and intermediaries were indispensable to this process.

1.3 The Carnatic Wars and European rivalry

The three Carnatic Wars (1746–48, 1749–54 and 1756–63) unfolded in the context of Anglo-French competition and succession disputes in Hyderabad and the Carnatic. The First reflected the War of Austrian Succession; the Second entangled rival claimants and company officers; the Third overlapped the Seven Years War. The British victory at Wandiwash in 1760, followed by the French loss of Pondicherry in 1761, weakened French prospects for territorial predominance. French commercial presence did not disappear; the outcome chiefly changed the balance of armed political influence.

1.4 Plassey, Buxar and diwani

At Plassey (1757), Robert Clive defeated Siraj ud-Daulah amid conspiracy and defections by important Bengali elites, including Mir Jafar. The battle was not an isolated proof of military superiority. Buxar (1764) was more consequential for consolidating military authority: Company forces defeated the combined armies of Mir Qasim, Shuja ud-Daulah and Shah Alam II. The Treaty of Allahabad (1765) gave the Company diwani rights over Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. A separation between nominal nawabi administration and Company revenue power produced serious accountability problems in the

early years.

2. Conquest, alliances and indirect rule

2.1 Mysore: four wars, adaptation and defeat

The Anglo-Mysore Wars (1767–69, 1780–84, 1790–92 and 1799) show that Indian states could mount sustained resistance and military innovation. Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan developed infantry, artillery, diplomatic contacts and rocket warfare. Tipu died defending Seringapatam in 1799. The defeat reflected changing alliances, resource constraints and coordinated Company campaigns, not a simple contrast between modern and backward armies. Mysore subsequently became a princely state under a restored Wodeyar dynasty.

2.2 Maratha confederacy and the logic of fragmentation

The three Anglo-Maratha Wars (1775–82, 1803–05 and 1817–18) arose amid disputes over peshwa succession, regional autonomy and Company intervention. The Treaty of Bassein (1802), signed by Peshwa Baji Rao II, accepted a subsidiary alliance and provoked opposition from other Maratha chiefs. Company success relied on diplomacy, selective wars and exploiting divided authority. The final defeat in 1818 ended the peshwa office while leaving several princely houses in place. It is misleading to imagine the confederacy as a perfectly unified state.

2.3 Punjab and the Anglo-Sikh Wars

Ranjit Singh built a formidable Sikh kingdom in Punjab, balancing European military expertise and indigenous institutions. Following his death in 1839, succession crises and tension between the Lahore court, Khalsa army and Company helped produce the First Anglo-Sikh War (1845–46). The Second (1848–49) ended in annexation of Punjab in 1849. The causes included internal politics, British frontier expansion and military confrontation; the Sikh army had demonstrated considerable organizational capability.

2.4 Subsidiary alliances and annexation

Under the subsidiary alliance system associated with Wellesley, rulers maintained British troops at their expense and accepted restrictions on independent foreign relations. The Doctrine of Lapse, associated with Dalhousie, was applied to selected states where the Company rejected adopted heirs as successors. Awadh was annexed in 1856 on a different stated ground, misgovernment. These instruments illustrate the difference between direct annexation and indirect paramountcy: both reduced sovereignty, but their legal and administrative forms varied.

3. Land revenue and agrarian restructuring

3.1 Permanent Settlement

The Permanent Settlement of 1793 in Bengal fixed the state demand on zamindars in perpetuity, treating them as landholders responsible for revenue. Officials hoped secure property rights would encourage improvement, but high initial demands, auctions for arrears and uneven landlord incentives often burdened cultivators. The state sacrificed possible increases in revenue while intermediaries could appropriate gains. The system was not uniform across India and should not be confused with a universal British land policy.

3.2 Ryotwari Settlement

Ryotwari arrangements, associated with Thomas Munro and other officials in parts of Madras and Bombay, assessed revenue directly on individual cultivators, although village institutions and local intermediaries remained influential. Periodic reassessment allowed the state to adjust demands. In theory it avoided a zamindar layer; in practice heavy assessments, uncertain harvests, credit dependence and coercive collection could still cause distress. Direct settlement did not mean secure or equitable peasant ownership everywhere.

3.3 Mahalwari Settlement

Mahalwari settlements, introduced in parts of the North-Western Provinces and elsewhere, assessed a village estate or mahal collectively, often with local proprietors or communities jointly responsible. Revenue was periodically revised. A comparison should track the unit of assessment, the recognized intermediary and the risk borne by cultivators, rather than memorizing three labels without their social effects.

3.4 Commercialization and debt

Commercialization meant greater orientation toward markets and cash crops such as indigo, cotton, opium, tea and jute. It could create income opportunities in favorable conditions but also exposed producers to price swings, debt, coercive contracts and food-crop displacement. Indigo cultivators in Bengal resisted exploitative planter relations in 1859–60. Deccan peasant unrest in 1875 reflected credit and revenue pressures alongside cotton-market volatility. Commercialization was a process, not a single policy, and effects differed by crop and region.

3.5 Landlessness and labor migration

Population pressure, indebtedness, loss of customary access and land transfers contributed to expanding groups of tenants, sharecroppers and landless agricultural workers in many regions. Yet agrarian stratification varied: some substantial peasants accumulated land and some cultivators retained bargaining power. Plantation recruitment, indentured migration and seasonal labor movement linked rural distress to wider colonial labor markets. Avoid claiming all peasants became landless or that every region followed the same chronology.

4. Industry, trade and the drain debate

4.1 Deindustrialization: mechanism and debate

Indian handloom and craft industries faced altered demand, tariff structures, machine-made British imports and changes in elite patronage. Some centers declined severely, while others adapted, specialized or survived. The concept of deindustrialization captures important regional employment and production shifts, but historians debate measurement, timing and whether all manufacturing contracted uniformly. Distinguish decline of particular handicrafts from the later growth of modern cotton mills, jute mills, coal mining and rail-related industries.

4.2 Drain of wealth

Dadabhai Naoroji argued that a portion of Indian income was transferred abroad without equivalent domestic return through home charges, official remittances, pensions, interest and payments connected with imperial administration. R. C. Dutt connected colonial fiscal and agrarian structures with impoverishment. Their critique was both economic and political: Indians paid for a government whose key decisions were made outside their control. For an analytical answer, distinguish the nationalists' normative concept of unrequited transfers from the more technical task of measuring net resource flows.

4.3 Trade and infrastructure as asymmetric integration

Colonial India increasingly exported raw materials and agricultural goods while importing British manufactured products. The pattern was not absolute: Indian entrepreneurs built cotton and jute industries and markets evolved over time. Railways lowered some transport costs, linked interior markets to ports and facilitated famine relief in certain circumstances, but freight priorities, guaranteed returns to investors and strategic routes also reflected imperial objectives. The same institution could generate economic benefits and reinforce unequal power.

4.4 Modern industry and indigenous enterprise

Bombay cotton mills, Bengal jute mills, coal mining and later iron and steel production demonstrate that colonial rule did not prevent all industrialization. Indian merchants and industrialists mobilized capital and technology under difficult conditions. The analytical issue is why industrial transformation was limited relative to potential: constrained mass purchasing power, uneven infrastructure, finance, policy preferences and global competition interacted. Avoid the false binary that colonialism produced either no modernization or universally beneficial modernization.

5. Famines, transport and communications

5.1 Famines: entitlement as well as rainfall

Drought and crop failures mattered, but famine mortality also depended on purchasing power, prices, food movement, public relief and state policy. The Great Famine of 1876–78 and the Bengal famine of 1943 illustrate distinct historical settings. The latter occurred during war and involved market disruption, inflation, administrative failure and loss of access to food; it cannot be reduced to drought. Colonial official responses changed over time, including famine commissions and codes, yet relief remained uneven.

5.2 Railways: two-sided assessment

The first passenger railway ran between Bombay and Thane in 1853. Railways expanded commodity markets, troop movement and administrative integration. The guarantee system protected returns to many early private investors, transferring substantial financial risk to Indian revenues. Rail links could move grain into scarcity regions, but distribution depended on prices and purchasing power; a railway alone did not ensure famine prevention. In mains answers, separate capacity from actual equitable outcomes.

5.3 Telegraph, post and imperial administration

The electric telegraph grew rapidly from the 1850s, allowing faster military and administrative communication. The postal reforms of 1854 helped establish a more integrated system. These networks enabled state surveillance and coordination but also assisted merchants, newspapers and eventually nationalist organization. Communications infrastructure therefore had contradictory political effects: it strengthened imperial command while enabling circulation of anti-colonial ideas.

5.4 Telangana and Hyderabad comparative lens

Hyderabad State was not governed through the same land-revenue regime as directly administered British provinces. The Nizam’s government operated within British paramountcy, while local jagirdari, revenue farming and later administrative reforms shaped agrarian relations. When discussing Telangana, explicitly distinguish princely-state institutions from the Permanent, Ryotwari and Mahalwari systems. British military and diplomatic influence in Hyderabad was real, but provincial colonial policies should not be mechanically mapped onto the region.

6. Historical method and integrated evaluation

6.1 Evidence and causality

Use a layered causal chain: Company trading privileges and local alliances → fiscal and military dominance → territorial administration → changing land and trade incentives → differentiated social outcomes. Do not treat the sequence as inevitable. Examine what contemporary records reveal and omit: official revenue returns may track collections but not household welfare; nationalist critiques reveal exploitation while requiring contextual economic analysis; local petitions illuminate resistance but are not representative of every village.

6.2 Balanced conclusion

Colonialism reorganized the economy around external political authority, unequal fiscal power and imperial trade priorities. It also built institutions and networks that Indian society used for purposes beyond imperial design. The decisive distinction is between the existence of a railway, legal code or market and the distribution of costs, benefits and decision-making power. A high-scoring answer weighs regional variation, change over time, agency of Indian actors and evidence rather than writing either a one-sided condemnation or a modernization celebration.

Visual Learning

The fiscal-military loop

Trading privileges → Political alliances → Military victories → Revenue rights → Larger army and credit → Further territorial influence

Revenue systems decision map

- Zamindar as revenue intermediary → Permanent Settlement (not every landlord relation was identical)

- Individual cultivator assessed → Ryotwari

- Village estate or mahal assessed → Mahalwari

Dual-use infrastructure matrix

| Institution | Colonial state advantage | Indian social/economic use |

|---|---|---|

| Railway | Troops, exports, port links | Mobility, internal trade, nationalist circulation |

| Telegraph | Rapid command and intelligence | Faster commercial information |

| Post | Administrative coordination | Correspondence, newspapers, political association |

Exam caution: Visuals are conceptual teaching aids, not source-verified statistical graphics.

Original Practice

MCQ 1

Which development most directly allowed the Company to fund expansion from Bengal revenues?

A. Treaty of Bassein B. Diwani grant of 1765 C. Annexation of Punjab D. First passenger railway

Answer: B. The diwani conferred revenue-collection rights in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. A is a later Maratha-related subsidiary alliance; C occurred in 1849; D in 1853.

MCQ 2

Which statement about Awadh in 1856 is most accurate?

A. Annexed under Doctrine of Lapse B. Annexed after the Third Carnatic War C. Annexed on the stated ground of misgovernment D. Annexed after the Second Anglo-Sikh War

Answer: C. British authorities justified annexation by allegations of misgovernment; it was not a Doctrine of Lapse case. The other options misstate the legal basis or chronology.

MCQ 3

Which pair correctly matches the settlement with its typical assessment unit?

A. Ryotwari–zamindar B. Mahalwari–village estate C. Permanent–individual ryot D. Mahalwari–port customs

Answer: B. Mahalwari typically assessed a village estate or mahal. Ryotwari centered on cultivators; Permanent Settlement relied on zamindars.

Mains prompts

1. Was British territorial expansion primarily a result of military superiority? (15 marks)

2. Assess the economic consequences of colonial land revenue settlements and commercialization. (15 marks)

3. Were colonial railways instruments of exploitation or modernization? (20 marks)

See answer-blueprints.md and complete-model-answers.md for worked responses.

Answer Blueprints

Q1 (15 marks). Was British territorial expansion primarily a result of military superiority?

Introduction (2–3 lines): The Company became a territorial state through a fiscal-military process involving Indian political divisions and alliances.

Body: (1) Carnatic Wars and European rivalry; (2) Plassey, elite defections and Buxar; (3) diwani and revenue-funded armies; (4) Mysore, Maratha and Sikh resistance; (5) subsidiary alliances and annexation.

Counterpoint: Company logistics and battlefield capacity mattered, but Indian states also adapted militarily.

Conclusion: Political coalition-building and fiscal extraction interacted with force.

Q2 (15 marks). Assess the economic consequences of colonial land revenue settlements and commercialization.

Introduction: Revenue policy restructured rights and incentives; market integration altered production and risk.

Body: Compare Permanent/Ryotwari/Mahalwari; high demand and credit; indigo and cotton; landlessness and uneven opportunities; famine vulnerability; regional variations.

Conclusion: Commercialization cannot be equated with development without examining bargaining power and welfare.

Q3 (20 marks). Evaluate whether railways were instruments of exploitation or modernization.

Introduction: State the dual-use thesis.

Body: Imperial troop mobility, port connectivity, guarantee costs; market integration, passenger mobility, communication; famine relief capacity versus entitlements; nationalist mobilization.

Conclusion: Judge distributional outcomes and institutional control, not technology alone.

Complete Model Answers

Q1. Was British territorial expansion primarily a result of military superiority? (15 marks)

The East India Company’s rise from a commercial corporation to a territorial ruler cannot be explained by military superiority alone. It was a fiscal-military and political transformation in which local alliances, revenue access, diplomacy and battlefield outcomes reinforced one another.

The Carnatic Wars demonstrated the value of European military organization, but they were fought amid disputes involving Indian claimants and regional courts. At Plassey in 1757, Siraj ud-Daulah’s defeat owed much to political conspiracy and defections, showing that a battle could settle an already fractured political contest. Buxar in 1764 was a stronger test of arms because the Company defeated a coalition involving Mir Qasim, Shuja ud-Daulah and Shah Alam II. The diwani grant of 1765 then supplied Bengal’s revenue, enabling a larger army and further territorial expansion.

Mysore, the Marathas and the Sikh kingdom reveal the limits of a technological-determinist explanation. Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan fought four wars with substantial military adaptation; the Maratha confederacy combined formidable forces with decentralized politics; Ranjit Singh developed an effective Punjab army. British success relied on changing coalitions, the Treaty of Bassein, subsidiary alliances, pressure on court politics and ultimately annexation. The Doctrine of Lapse and the annexation of Awadh illustrate that legal and administrative instruments complemented war.

Thus, military capacity was necessary but insufficient. The Company's decisive advantage emerged when coercive power, Indian collaborators and access to Indian fiscal resources formed a self-reinforcing system. An adequate historical explanation must recover Indian agency rather than depicting conquest as inevitable.

Q2. Assess the economic consequences of colonial land revenue settlements and commercialization. (15 marks)

Colonial revenue settlements reshaped agrarian property claims and obligations, while commercialization tied cultivation more closely to cash markets. Their consequences depended on local ecology, bargaining power and the burden of revenue collection.

The Permanent Settlement of 1793 fixed the government demand on zamindars in Bengal but did not guarantee security for tenants. Revenue arrears and auctions could destabilize estates, and landlords often had incentives to extract rents. Ryotwari arrangements assessed cultivators directly in parts of Madras and Bombay, yet periodic revision and high demands could still intensify indebtedness. Mahalwari settlements placed responsibility on village estates or proprietary bodies and likewise exposed cultivators to collective fiscal pressure. None was an all-India model.

Cash crops such as indigo, cotton, opium and jute linked farmers to expanding trade networks. Some producers benefited from demand and transport access, but many faced price volatility, costly credit, coercive contracts and vulnerability when food prices rose. Indigo resistance and the Deccan disturbances demonstrate that market participation could coexist with unequal power. Land transfers and debt contributed to landlessness in some regions, though substantial cultivators and entrepreneurial farmers also emerged.

Revenue extraction and commercialization must therefore be assessed together: cash obligations pushed cultivators toward markets, while volatile markets could undermine their capacity to pay. The outcome was uneven integration without reliable welfare gains. For Telangana, the institutions of princely Hyderabad must be analyzed separately from British provincial settlements.

Q3. Were colonial railways instruments of exploitation or modernization? (20 marks)

Colonial railways were both transformative infrastructure and instruments shaped by imperial priorities. Their economic and political effects cannot be reduced to either a purely exploitative or a purely modernizing narrative.

Railway construction connected inland producing regions with ports and enabled faster movement of raw materials, manufactured imports and troops. Strategic routes strengthened the colonial state. Early financial arrangements, especially guaranteed returns to investors, could shift risk onto Indian revenues while profits and procurement benefits flowed outward. Railways therefore belonged to the wider fiscal and commercial architecture of empire.

At the same time, cheaper and faster transport expanded market integration, passenger movement and access to some employment and trading opportunities. Indian entrepreneurs used the network for commerce. Railways could move grain toward famine-affected areas, but transport availability did not ensure affordability: poverty, inflation and unequal purchasing power could prevent people from accessing food. The technology also helped spread newspapers, ideas and activists, indirectly strengthening nationalist networks.

A sound assessment separates technical capacity, ownership and finance, distribution of gains, and political control. The railways undeniably changed India's economic geography, yet their planning and financing were not designed primarily around equitable Indian development. Their long-run public utility and their colonial political economy are both essential to the answer.

Verified MCQs

None authenticated in this production pass. Original teaching MCQs appear separately in original-practice.md; they are not represented as previous-year questions.

Verified Mains PYQs

None authenticated in this production pass. Do not mistake the original mains prompts and model answers for official TGPSC questions.

Current Affairs

Verification pending (research cutoff: 22 October 2026). No new 2026 policy, archaeological or archival news item is asserted without a verified dated primary source.

Useful contemporary connections to research before final approval: digitization of colonial revenue records; conservation of railway heritage; new economic-history research on famines and trade; Hyderabad State archival initiatives. These are research leads, not reported events.

References

Stable foundational reading (bibliographic references; chapter-level checks pending)

- Bipan Chandra, *History of Modern India* (Orient BlackSwan): colonial conquest, economic critique and nationalism.

- Sekhar Bandyopadhyay, *From Plassey to Partition and After* (Orient BlackSwan): political and social history with historiographical discussion.

- Tirthankar Roy, *The Economic History of India, 1857–1947* (Oxford University Press): economic change and regional variation.

- Irfan Habib, *Indian Economy under Early British Rule, 1757–1857* (Tulika Books): early colonial economy.

- NCERT, *Our Pasts III* and *Themes in Indian History*, relevant chapters (edition-dependent).

- TGPSC Group-I Services Notification 02/2024, Annexure-II (official syllabus; text in syllabus-index.md).

Source audit limits

These references are a reading guide, not proof that each sentence has been page-verified. Official PYQ sources and contemporary developments require independent checks before approval.

Quality Audit

- [x] Topic mapped to existing official-syllabus transcription

- [x] Multi-section explanatory draft, chronology, revenue comparison, Telangana distinction

- [x] Three original explained MCQs

- [x] Three original mains questions with blueprints and full model answers

- [x] Self-contained PDF generated and linked

- [ ] Every historical claim checked against page-level scholarly sources

- [ ] Official PYQs authenticated

- [ ] Dated current affairs source-verified

- [ ] Independent expert review and final approval

Decision: EXPANDED DRAFT ONLY — NOT APPROVED.

British Colonial Expansion and Economic Transformation — critical mains facts

TGPSC Group I Mains | Paper II | Detailed educational draft | NOT academically approved

High-value evidence and analytical connections

Battle–Treaty–Provision–Consequence: mandatory exam matrix

| War / political settlement | Treaty / date | Specific settlement and significance |

|---|---|---|

| First Anglo-Mysore War | Treaty of Madras, 1769 | Mutual restitution of conquests and a defensive-assistance commitment; demonstrates Company vulnerability to Haidar Ali. |

| Second Anglo-Mysore War | Treaty of Mangalore, 1784 | Broad restoration of conquests and prisoners after sustained Mysore resistance; not a British annexation settlement. |

| Third Anglo-Mysore War | Treaty of Seringapatam, 1792 | Tipu Sultan surrendered about half his territory, paid indemnity and provided hostages as security; a major territorial and fiscal setback. |

| Fourth Anglo-Mysore War | Fall of Seringapatam, 1799 | Tipu died; subsequent partition and Wodeyar restoration under British predominance. Do not invent a '1799 Treaty of Seringapatam' as the war-ending counterpart to 1792. |

| First Anglo-Maratha War | Treaty of Salbai, 1782 | Broad restoration and recognition arrangements, settling the Company–Maratha conflict for a period. |

| Maratha political crisis | Treaty of Bassein, 1802 | Peshwa Baji Rao II accepted subsidiary troops and constraints on foreign relations; provoked confederacy opposition and helped precipitate the Second Anglo-Maratha War. |

| First Anglo-Sikh War | Treaty of Lahore, 9 March 1846 | Loss of Jalandhar Doab and indemnity; must be paired with the Treaty of Amritsar (16 March 1846) involving Gulab Singh and Kashmir, and the Treaty of Bhairowal (December 1846) strengthening British supervision of Lahore government. |

| Second Anglo-Sikh War | Annexation of Punjab, 1849 | No interchangeable 'Treaty of Lahore 1849'; conflict ended in annexation under Dalhousie. |

| Bengal conquest | Treaty of Allahabad, 1765 | Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa from Shah Alam II; transformed the Company's fiscal capacity. |

Analytical instruction: Each war answer must explain *why the treaty mattered*. The sequence is combat and negotiation → territory or indemnity → subsidiarity/paramountcy → fiscal resources → further coercive capacity. A simple list of battles misses the examination's causal core. Distinguish the historical documents from later national narratives and verify spellings/individual clauses from primary treaty compilations during final review.

Verification gate: a primary-source or scholarly page-level audit is still required before these educational summaries can be marked approved.